

Juan P. Aparicio

Economist & Data Scientist | Causal Inference, Forecasting, Experimentation

PhD economist who built a demand-forecasting product line used with Fortune 500 clients and runs large-scale research-verification projects, including a PNAS randomized evaluation of how AI changes analyst accuracy and throughput.

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Location: Medellín, Colombia | Authorized to work in Canada (employer-sponsored permit) | Open to remote

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GitHub: <https://github.com/juposada93>

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Methods: causal inference (difference-in-differences, instrumental variables, event studies), randomized experiments and A/B testing, time-series and demand forecasting, predictive modeling, survey data analysis at scale, human-AI evaluation.
- Languages & tools: R, Python, SQL, Stata, Git/GitHub, LaTeX, Excel.
- Data infrastructure: Snowflake, MariaDB.
- Human languages: Spanish (native), English (C1), basic French and Portuguese.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Research Scientist, Institute for Replication** | Ottawa, Canada | 2024-present. Designs and runs large-scale crowd-sourced research-verification projects ("replication games"); led studies with 700+ analyst-participants and co-managed projects spanning 2,000+ researchers. Designed, ran, and co-wrote a randomized evaluation assigning 288 researchers to 103 human-only, AI-assisted, and AI-led teams, measuring how AI changes verification accuracy and speed (published in PNAS, 2026). Co-investigator on USD 322K in competitive research funding (2025).
- **Senior Economist & Senior Data Scientist, CivicScience** | Pittsburgh, USA | 2022-2024. Founded the company's demand-forecasting practice — no forecasting offering existed before. Built forecasting applications in R, Python, and SQL on CivicScience's real-time survey platform (165M+ consumer profiles); acquired and led the engagements with Fortune 500 clients including McDonald's, Target, and Bank of America. The work was productized into a commercial forecasting line; continues as a CivicScience fellow and advisor (2024-present).
- **Postdoctoral Researcher & Senior Consultant, Universidad EAFIT** | Medellín, Colombia | 2022-2023. Led EAFIT's consulting engagement with the Federación Nacional de Departamentos on illicit liquor and cigarette markets; delivered a book-length policy report informing national anti-contraband strategy.

EDUCATION

- Ph.D. in Economics, University of Western Australia | 2023. Dean's list honorable mention.
- M.Sc. in Economics, Université catholique de Louvain | 2018.
- B.S. in Economics, Universidad EAFIT | 2016. Graduated with honors.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- AI-assisted teams outperform AI-led teams but not human-only teams in assessing research reproducibility in quantitative social science. **PNAS**, 2026. Randomized comparison of human vs. AI-assisted vs. AI-led analyst teams — directly applicable to evaluating GenAI tooling for analytics organizations.
- Captivating news: Media attention and FARC kidnappings. **Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization**, 2022. Natural-experiment identification on daily event data: how information shifts the behavior of strategic actors.
- Peacefully Demobilizing Rebels. **IZA Discussion Paper 16054** (under review, European Economic Review). Quasi-experimental evaluation of a national persuasion campaign: which message framing changed behavior, and when.